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ServiceNow, Ansible, AI Ops, automation, incident management, playbooks, governance, integration, incident resolution, deterministic outcomes, ROI, zero-touch automation, event-driven architecture, ServiceNow LEAP, Red Hat.



SPEAKERS

Speaker 5, Speaker 3, Speaker 7, Speaker 1, Speaker 2, Speaker 4, Speaker 6

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Speaker 1 00:00

The fun backstory to how we got connected. So Red Hat is the partner with ServiceNow, as you all are well aware, and have extensive integration to service now for years, from an icon perspective in AI ops. So Sri came across a blog that I had written late last year, and reached out on LinkedIn, and we got anyway, got connected, and he said to me last week, he said, Look at us. Now. We're on stage together. So we have a lot of like, we're really excited about solution. We're glad y'all are here. And I should ask too, how many of you were had an opportunity to be at the spotlight session yesterday for Ansible there were people so you saw Sri on the panel. So that's awesome. We really excited about that. So yeah, so we will jump in. So first slide is just what we hope that you will walk away with today is how ServiceNow leap and Ansible actually connect AI power discovery to govern execution. We'll also be sharing some use cases. So we want you to walk away with those

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Speaker 2 01:01

real quick thing here. So I assume everybody here uses ServiceNow. Is that correct in some way, fashion or form, right? Who here uses ITSM for service now? We here uses Itom for ServiceNow. So it's a little bit smaller, just out of curiosity. And of those in the Itom space, are you guys utilizing any AI ops capability within that or no? Anybody know what AI Ops is? That's a better

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Speaker 3 01:31

question. Just start.

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Speaker 2 01:34

Just start. So we're gonna, you're gonna, we're gonna learn about a little bit of what AI Ops is in the session, and we're going to go through a pretty long demo around the service medley.

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Speaker 1 01:46

Yeah, definitely. And then so we'll get into how a apps is helping to bridge the gap between automation and service management teams. So he kind of ran through this already, what we're going to cover today, so we're going to cover that again. But this is just an overview to show. Hey, as you all know, we have extensive integrations with ServiceNow and where we are going to be focusing today, in this AI apps realm, and specifically in the iTunes realm, with the LEAP solution that we're going to show history here. By now, you've heard, heard the term certainly. But I know there are many definitions of the term out there in the market, but we are specifically talking about turning operational insight into intelligent, automated outcomes and then so these are this industry, and I have talked a lot about this in terms of the different personas, right? I think a common challenge that we hear frequently from customers is your automation teams and ServiceNow teams often sit in different parts of the organization, which presents a number of challenges that we're excited to help address with this joint solution, one of those being operational costs and potentially duplicating automation across platforms, not being able To utilize what already exists, again, that leads into underutilized investments. And then, of course, lower incident resolution is a challenge in terms of some of the manual handoff and then the trust barriers. We talked a lot about trust and deterministic outcomes, and I'll cover that in the Ansible section in just a minute. You've heard me talk about it extensively, probably yesterday, in the spotlight if you were in that session, and then coordination as well between what can often be siloed teams within the organization. So a quick overview here. This is Ansible specific to aiops. So again, accelerating incident response, right, but reducing meantime resolution, producing consistent automation. We talk a lot here in the in the deterministic realm, and something that is very, you know, appealing and helpful is having a pre tested, reusable playbooks, right that are going to execute the same, the same, proven things every time, and then governing the AI execution. So AI recommends what you're it's within the boundaries of what your team defines, what you have built in with Ansible, already built in with a platform with role based access control, audit trails, approval

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Speaker 4 04:08

gates,

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Speaker 1 04:09

and then again, another key benefit, and I'll go into this in just in the next slide, which is remediating across domains, so having the ability to automate across leading to the next slide, network, operating system, cloud, virtualization, security. So this is just a few samples of the ecosystem partners that we integrate with across the board, but just really beneficial. Ansible is not designed to work in isolation. So really, really great benefit there. And then I'll have a couple slides here, just really emphasizing the importance of the foundation of automation, and especially as you are looking at getting into aiops and agentic. So again, what are the benefits that, as well, can help with right translation of operational SME into reusable, testable, human readable code, as well as documentation of the approved processes with the auditable trail, and then, of course, creating consistent, scalable, reliable policy enforcement as well. And you may have heard me talk about this yesterday, but the key benefit right of this automation library is it really is your security boundary. We'll talk a little bit about MCP integration with this joint solution, and, you know, giving AI models and agents an interface to interact with Ansible but it's they can discover and execute existing automation, right? It's your existing already approved, already you know, you have that trust mirror, you've got the RBAC, you've got the audit trails as well. So you're not giving AI an ability to go rope and create things ad hoc, and then these are our core kind of values. With this at the top is, the more, the more you automate, the better. The more you actually have in that foundation of automation, the better, especially as you get into again, as you get into AI ops and agentic, the more you have automated again, across your whole infrastructure, the better you're going to be to be ready for the next, next round here, I'm going to pass it over to Sri to give an overview of me, and then we'll get into the demo right after that.

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Speaker 5 06:13

That's awesome. So firstly, let's congratulate Red Hat to put a fantastic no show, because they really deserve it. Deserve. Second appreciation is for the people in the first rows. Because if you think about nostalgic moments, nobody wants to sit in the first

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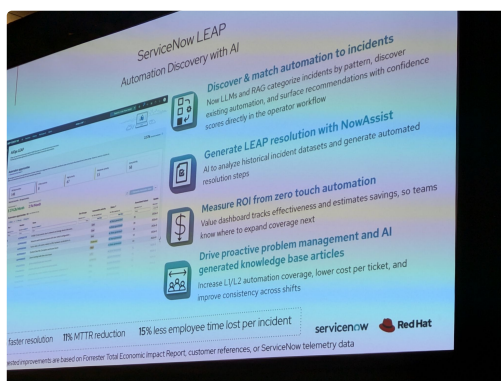
Speaker 4 06:32

row.

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Speaker 5 06:32

We have some brave souls here. Thank you. So my name is Srinivas. I go by Sri ID, the item product line of business for nine years with ServiceNow, prior to this, products in HP and Walmart, when you think about AI ops, right, the term AI Ops is again, used in multiple dimensions. But let me give you a 32nd pitch on why this is this really matters. Most of you service management. You use incident, prod, no problem. Change. You need the incident no tickets to be created from your monitoring tools. But when you think about your monitoring stack, there's so many monitoring tools out there in the market. We have infrastructure monitoring, service monitoring, synthetic monitoring, your APM tools like Dynatrace, APPD, New Relic. There's enough tools there, but the place where you need aiops or event intelligence platform, it is in the correlation you need to connect all those event signals, metrics, logs, you correlate, you bind it with your service context so that we can create meaningful context, rich incidents, right? Then there's another problem. Okay, I've created an incident, but the story doesn't end. I don't want to send a ticket to somebody or, like, manually troubleshoot this. And this is exactly the place no leap comes in. Leap stands for learning enhance automation platform. I'm going to, like explain the concept in nobody with these two hats. Okay, so firstly, I'm going to wear an Ansible hat. Now I'm an Ansible automation architect, have the best automation platform now in the industry, I can automate anything, but the problem I have is I don't know what to automate. I You need to look at like Incident Management stream to understand, okay, where the problem lies, so that I can first understand, discover the automation opportunities, right? And then, like, I can work on those automation candidates. The second problem that we solve for an civil automation architects, it's like, what is the value ROI you create? Because you guys are awesome. You guys are technologists. You guys can create playbooks. But is those playbooks generating value to the business, right? I don't want to create a playbook that can delete a core file, disk space. These are all plumbing work technology layer, but you need to attack know the playbooks that really matters for the business, right? Onboarding, orchestration, right, making sure the changes right can fully be automated. So ROI, measuring ROI and identifying the right automation opportunity is the place where no visa. Let me put a service now hand, right so now, as a service now, guy like we can always say that, okay, service now is an incident management or no orchestration layer in a solid last mile automation tool, right where we can connect.



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Speaker 3 09:22

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Speaker 5 09:23

the problem is these two worlds are fragmented, service management world and automation world. They don't talk to each other, right? Service now has all the intelligence knows exactly where the problem is, but we need that like powerful automation story with no answerable like platform. So that's exactly where NEAP comes in. Because what leap does is like, firstly, it performs and clustering analysis of all your incident data for the last six months. You might have created like 100,000 decades, but let ai do the thinking. AI is thinking what to automate, although this is probabilistic in nature, the thinking aspect

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Speaker 6 10:00

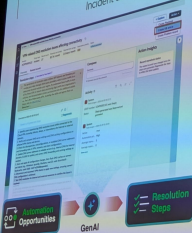
of AI is very powerful, right? And

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Speaker 5 10:02

you have heard repeatedly that you need deterministic, action oriented playbooks that will do the last mile automation. Right now, we are converting the thinking aspect, you are having a workflow aspect, and then you have an automation that is deterministic flow that's doing the last mile automation. So the AI specialist, the AI experiences that we have built, it will tell you what to automate, what is ROI for automation, and secondly, leap can also help you in other dimensions, like you can generate knowledge based article help you in Problem Management, like most of the customers, like when knowledge based articles are all used as the first level of incident deflection. This is all great, but the real power comes when you connect these two powerful platforms together, the service management platform, we believe that, like we have built the best in class, unified data model on top of it, Incident, Problem, change, security risk, all those products are using. Know the service now, task, workflow based experiences, and now we need to connect to the answerable world to first understand what kind of playbooks someone has created, if no leap is telling you what to automate, and if you don't have know those playbooks, can we inform automation engineers saying, Hey, here's the ROI that comes for the business. If you know, work on this top 10 incident categories, which are all repeatable. But the cool thing is, like, leap can also tell you how humans have resolved that category of incident. It's not just like, Oh, I haven't no 1000 tickets in one cluster you need to automate. But it will tell you, like, how the operations team have troubleshooted, triage that category of incident. The AI creates a problem, a set of library, a set of steps, standard operating procedure, which can further be sent to the Ansible automation team to build, to curate, know those labels. So we want to share, like some practical use cases I'm going to invite so my good friend will tell you that some of the no use cases where you can apply this today,

ServiceNow LEAP
Incident deflection strategy with Knowledge base



AI Specialist to auto create knowledge base articles

18.6% of tickets closed by higher-tier support could have been resolved at Level 1 support specialist if proper KB articles had been used.

Opportunities GenAI Resolution Center

servicenow Red Hat

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Speaker 2 12:14

who here has been any of my sessions earlier this conference, and you will all know that I have talked about AI ops and practical use cases, some of these use cases you may have heard before, because those are very low hanging fruit and very common in the IT realm. So let's go ahead and get started. We're going to be talking today in basically four Well, there's four areas that connect to the Ansible, but we're going to be talking gonna be talking about today is from an MCP standpoint, right? This is a true AI type of interface where we also have a tie in to event driven Ansible through event driven architecture. Who here uses the VA? I see three hands all right. Now, there we go. And then we also have connections with API. This is where most people come in. Who you hear is the API within. There we go. And then we also have the web UI through our platform and controller. Is that correct? Right? Everybody does that at some point. But what we're going to be talking about today is those use cases that MCP can really, really help out with the Ansible and talking with, say, ServiceNow. So how it works? So you have basically get an automation discovery with Red Hat Ansible. You're going to get an AI detection of the actual automation opportunity from ServiceNow, and then that agent is going to connect the Ansible MCP server to basically find what Ansible playbooks are that are out there in wherever you have it at, whether that's in your private automation hub or your GitHub, or wherever it may be, or in the future portal, anybody's going to Use portal. And then it provides the available Ansible automation back to lead. And what ends up happening is that automation architect is going to connect Ansible playbooks to the automation opportunities basically put it putting a push pin in there to basically connect them. Right this bottom screen is just basically an example of what you're going to see from an Ansible standpoint, and also from a ServiceNow standpoint. And you will be this process is going to go through the entire process of applying that zero touch fix to automation. Now I would like to stress here, guys, is that you can absolutely do zero touch fix, or you can build as much community approval action that you want in there, right? I have said this in all my sessions, and this has really hit home with everybody. You may or may not be comfortable putting AI in charge of your production environment straight away, you can put human approval in there is not a no brainer that's still an AI op situation that still absolutely has service now leave, and still absolutely adds Ansible provides you a little bit of a protection layer and maybe a little bit of ease of mind, right? So essentially, we get the event alert from where you're alerting from, in this case, ServiceNow, and you're going to get AI Ops is going to collect that event, right, and it's going to correlate and trigger incident workflows with the service now an AI agent flows that recommends the AI platform, and the AI automation is run on the IT infrastructure based on your choices of what playbooks, modules, workflows, job templates that you have out there, right? And this can hit any type of endpoint that you have. Who here has a Windows environment that you're automating with Ansible? Who here has the networking environment you're automating? Who here knows about our certified content for all these things? And where does that sit? Not

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Speaker 3 16:00

my compliment,

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Speaker 2 16:01

someone else's problem. It, where do we download certified content from? Not the right answer. That's correct. Galaxy is not supported. Galaxy is wild, wild west, just as an FYI. Now that's not to say that there's not certified content out there. If you only want certified content, automation hub is the only place to go. I just want to clear that a lot of people think galaxy is the end all be all. We love galaxy. I even have a repo that's out there under my name, if you can find it good job. But certified content that you're going to be utilizing automation from that is supported by Red Hat is always going to be an automation. And then what ends up happening is we remediate the issue, and we can close the alert and the incident within ServiceNow. All throughout this process, this can also be tied back into your ITSM so we know ticket can be opened, ticket can be updated, ticket can be closed, and whatnot. I'm happy, right? So with that, I'm going to start the demo, and I'm going to hand it off to Sri to cover the service analysis side of the demo, and we will get started if you have any questions after where we'll take questions after the demo and through, Michelle will be going through with a microphone to with any questions you might have. So, all right. So who here is familiar with the screen? All right, so this is the Automate automation platform GUI screen, and we're going to basically start here by connecting to the Ansible automation platform. And we're going to select Access Management. I'm going to go through this pretty quickly, because you guys really don't care about how to set up Ansible, but I just want to show you that it is very simple to be to get connected to an head, to serves now, and all this process is done once period. Once it's set up, you're good to go. You're basically going to create an API token for your account, and then you're going to go over to service now,

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Speaker 5 18:26

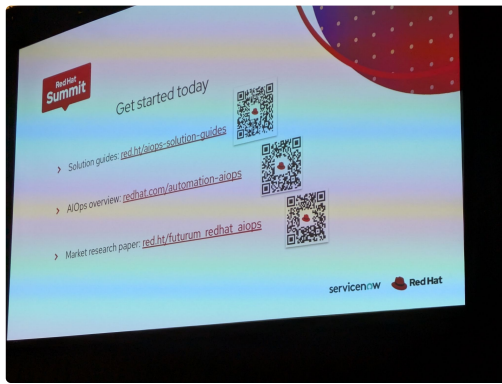
okay, awesome. Once you have got your API keys, that's the keys your kingdom, right? So as an automation architect, sitting in service now, so you will go to leave, leave stands for learning enhance automation platform, right? As I said, the screen that you are witnessing is showing all the automation opportunities, right? This is coming from your data. AI is analyzing the last six month incident categories and coming out with automation opportunities. Let's say that once you have it like the most important thing for your leaders, it's like, I want zero touch automation powered by Ansible automation platform. So as an admin, you will have a connected to red Ansible so you'll say that, hey, I'm just giving you the API key and the MCP server to connect to AP, right? You save it now the connection is established, right? Now you have connected two powerful platforms that can exchange information about what to automate. If you have playbooks, then those playbooks can also be recommended by the AI agents from ServiceNow. So we talked about this use case. The first use case is all about finding the right automation opportunities and looking for a potential playbook from the Ansible site. And we need to connect and bind these two categories together. And for that like the idea is like, yeah, ServiceNow will call the MCP server. The MCP server will return us the potential playbooks, and you're going to see how that match happens in ServiceNow with the learning enhance automation platform. So if I am in the automation architect looking for potential automation discovery jobs, I can open a category. And what you see here the generated resolution nodes, the resolution notes in incident management is the place where humans interact with incidents. So you have lot of your operations team, your server team, your middleware team, your application team, going to constantly update incident resolution notes, saying, Yeah, I looked at that category of incident, and I've like, given you step one, step one, step three. And AI is analyzing and bringing those steps for the purpose of automation. And

then if any of those steps where it finds a potential playbook, the AI agent will automatically map the playbook to the incident resolution steps. This is step number one, because now you have identified the opportunity. Now you have identified how humans have interacted with this category of incidents, and you have identified the steps. And for each steps, AI agent is now looking for a potential playbook that is already available in Ansible. Now you're going to, like, just connect and bind right? The step two is like, if you don't have a playbook, that is a place where now the service now architect team, I told you about these two caps. These two caps have to merge right in your like organization. If you your team and ServiceNow team is not talking to each other, please use this leap and MCP integration as the opportunity to know blend and come out with no better ROI solutions. Let's say that you have built a playbook you automatically match all those steps. So now the magic happens, because as an automation team, you have connected two powerful platforms together. But then comes the next big thing, like for your service desk team, who are non technologists, like you have IT operators. All they do is, like, look at all the map big screens and like, hey, they need tools. They need like, they are first responders, but they're not technologists, right? So when the next time the incident comes in the service operation space, like, where, if I'm a service desk analyst, able, I'm logging into my workspace and I have some work to do, and there's a file of incidents coming in. We are showing how the map automation opportunity to the playbook will be shown to able on the right side panel. Like here, it's an HTTP service. Some configuration change right on you will automatically see how Lee is able to find Hey. They are all these are all the standard operating procedures that you need to follow in order to troubleshoot and triage. But you know what? I have got a magic bullet. If you click on the magic bullet right where the AI agent from service. Now, very tough to answer them. Say, You are the muscle, right? You have connection to those servers. You can automate. You can run the playbooks. So this is how the know, the deterministic playbooks can be fully automated and orchestrated from ServiceNow, where the Service Desk team, they don't have to go and learn Ansible automation platform. You are making the Service Desk specialist superstars because they are able to click on that magic bullet. Know the playbook runs. The Playbook can perform what it always does, but once the playbook executes, then ServiceNow also captures ROI metrics. How many of those incident categories where, if the mean time to repair is two weeks, where tickets growing around humans? So now you are bringing automation and giving it in the hands of service desk specialists. This is human in the process. But Service Desk node team also has now copilot experiences. Service now launched something called AI specialists. And these specialists think like human these specialists can be a co worker, you can onboard them, and these specialists can also run playbooks. So we are giving both options to the customers to decide which pathway to choose, either you bring in service desk to trigger the playbook manually, or you have AI agents and AI specialists that will automatically know run those playbooks. Capture the ROI metrics, capture the know the power on, like whether the playbook is able to resolve that incident. So with that right, you can clearly see the platforms are connected. The platforms are no intelligent you're bringing the power of AI where AI thinks service now orchestrates, but Ansible automation platform that shows you the muzzle right, where the last mile automation happens and the zero touch automation experiences now not in marketing buzzword, but it's reality can happen in your estate. So with that, not like you want to finish some value statements.

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Speaker 2 25:22

So you may have seen this on the other screen. So what is the value of an service that lead the idea for everybody here is that we need to figure out what the problem is in a faster manner, right? We need to have a faster mean time resolution. The average mean time to get this stat was on my others, my other conferences to sessions to the average time to take to resolve a ticket is about 3537 minutes. It could range from a simple restarting service or a user needs to be reset. Differs in time that could be a lot quicker than others, right? But when you incorporate AI or even EDA, you can actually resolve that faster, and the typical Meantime, resolution drops to about two to three minutes when you include automation and service now. So you know, reuse what you build, leap, basically services, what you already have that you may not know about. You give it access. You can see when you give it access to AAP, it searches AP for the content you have you can potentially put forward and you deliver consistent outcomes. Who here thinks AI without governance is a great idea. I see you in the corner. He's anarchist. I like it. So when you with one of the one of the big things about the Ansible automation platform is the governance that it goes around AI, and it's consistent in everything that you do. So when you have the content that you've already created, great, you still provide consistency around that and lessening human error in those configuration changes. Oops, I accidentally set the real wrong VLAN for this particular account, or I opened up a public IP on an s3 bucket. Probably not a good idea, depending on what you want to do. You're breaking down those silos in terms of what your your those domains that are going to be utilizing potentially the same tool and have the same nomenclature. I know it's pipe dream. We've been talking about breaking down silos for 15 to 20 years, but I really do believe that within today's day and age, that silos will be breaking down, or at least blurring a bit across different organizations. And again, we're going to be providing those guardrails for our with our back and audibility trails and all that good jazz. So the key takeaways here is that you cannot have intelligence without execution, right? It's, it is, is just a recommendation service. Now, leap finds that automation Red Hat turns that into an actual executable with governance. And that's really what I want to stress here, governance, governance, governance, especially in today's AI world, stop reinventing when you when you can automate what you've already automated, what you can automate. Service now, leave discovers that Ansible playbook that you may have and service them directly to the service now, operator workflow, right, one click, no expertise required. As long as there's RBAC and rights to those users, they can actually kick off the automation, and aiops bridges the gap between the automation and the service management teams. AI can connect the teams, matching the pardon me, matching the detective issues to the existing remediation and in real time, the service now and the automation teams are working together rather than complaining about each other. Also, one quick thing just heads up with anything with ServiceNow, you don't need admin rights to service now for Ansible that had that brought up to me the other day, someone said, well, our ServiceNow team says we can't do Ansible automation because we've asked for basically God rights, and we always go by the rule of least privileged access. Something just needs a right. Give it a right. Doesn't need to read. Just give it a read, right? No pun intended there in the last comment. So one thing I do want to put this up here for a little bit. Please get out your camera. That's especially the first one solution. Guys, you will want to know this. We have a full solution guide around ServiceNow lead that you can download and well, it's actually a website that you can utilize and reuse and download for your uses, basically, architects, Gavin, best practices. We also have an AI ops overview and a market research paper with future I don't know if anybody saw the webinar, so with that, we're going to turn it over for q&a. If anybody has questions, please ask Michelle, not sure you're myself,



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Speaker 7 30:30

something I might have missed. Maybe Aaron just didn't fully understand. So leap is provided by service. Now that partner, that's the service. Now have Okay,

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Speaker 5 30:41

not speak. We just announced lot of AI agents for this. So there's an AI agent for duplicates. There's an agent for stainless identify, ownership location, so there's a different AI agent category of me.